

Lisa Kanouse

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Professional Summary

Senior Event Producer and Fashion Industry professional with deep roots in both large-scale live production and the full fashion supply chain. Career spans large-scale show production, runway and trunk show direction, photo styling and art direction, product development across \$26M–\$85M businesses at Federated, May Company, and Saks, and founding a children's apparel brand with full runway and lookbook creative direction. Recognized for “turning the most complex, high-pressure projects into smooth, successful outcomes” and for “creating tangible value for the executive team and the broader organization.” At Fanatics, led stage production for 100,000+ attendees across two flagship events while developing the first proprietary Fanatics Fest apparel collection, which ranked #2 in sales at FFNYC24. Known for building the project infrastructure, cross-functional alignment, and vendor relationships that deliver high-stakes, brand-defining events on time and on budget.

Employment

Senior Executive Assistant | Event Program Manager • Aug 2025 – Present • New York

Collibra

- Produce and own a global executive event portfolio: Executive Producer for the Collibra Club Annual Trip to Four Seasons Marrakesh (60 guests, destination management, creative direction, experience design, curated luxury gifting) and 3-Day Executive Summit at Augustine Hotel Prague (60 senior leaders, destination selection, hotel negotiations, 15% savings, 4.89/5.0 logistics score).
- Build and maintain all project plans: timelines, deliverables, milestones, budgets, and post-event reconciliation across a multi-event global portfolio.
- Serve as primary liaison between the C-Suite, external agencies, vendors, and internal teams, facilitating regular status meetings, tracking action items, and ensuring alignment across all workstreams.
- Create executive-ready presentation decks communicating event strategy, progress, and outcomes to senior leadership.

Event Program Manager • Jun 2022 – Nov 2024 • New York

Fanatics Events

- Developed the first proprietary Fanatics Fest apparel collection, aggregating sales data across Fanatics Retail, Mitchell & Ness, Lids, and brand partners to validate the product line. The collection ranked #2 in sales at FFNYC24 across all major leagues.
- Led end-to-end stage production for Fanatics Fest NYC 2024: 3 stages, 200+ talent, 60+ programs, 75K attendees, \$2M+ budget. Developed content, built full programming lineup, directed 40+ cross-functional department leads including A/V, stage management, talent relations, security, and graphics. Delivered 95% on-time programming across 3 days.
- Led production for WWE World at WrestleMania 2024: 5 stages, 100+ talent, 60+ programs, 30K attendees. Created and implemented detailed run-of-show through stakeholder collaboration.
- Managed vendor relationships with Freeman (overall production) and Sparks (brand deck guidelines and booth design). Oversaw VIP experience, greenroom design, premium F&B, and curated gifting for 300+ VIPs and talent.
- Led sponsorship activations, on-site lead capture, and full post-event reconciliation including budget wrap-up and performance reporting.

Executive Personal Assistant | Event Producer • Mar 2020 – Jun 2022 • New York

Shopify

- Produced private brand launch events for HiddenNY, Reese Cooper, and Victor Victor: 1,000+ guests, 40+ A-list talent including Pharrell, Nigo, and KAWS. Victor Victor event achieved 14K impressions over 2 days, 3.1% engagement rate, +7% over foot traffic goal.
- Developed scalable run-of-show frameworks, budget templates, and post-event analytics to standardize event execution across the Creator Team.
- Built and led a five-person EA team: hiring, onboarding, and service standards across the Senior Leadership Team.

Executive Producer | Chief of Staff • Mar 2012 – Mar 2020 • New York

UHNWI Family: Celebrity Chef Gabriele Corcos & Actress Debi Mazar

- Produced approximately 100 private events, brand activations, and entertainment engagements. Oversaw brand partnerships from negotiation through activation across media, culinary, and lifestyle categories. Served as Executive Producer and Creative Director for Counter Talk Live and Future Bites: led concept development from initial vision through format design, built and managed the production team, directed on-air logistics and talent coordination, oversaw content strategy, and shepherded both projects from pilot through full season delivery including a live presentation at SXSW.
- Cataloged Debi Mazar's lifelong photographic archives in Adobe Lightroom for her memoir, managing asset organization, tagging, and editorial selection across decades of fashion and entertainment imagery.
- Managed day-to-day operations of a brick-and-mortar restaurant and private event venue: staffing, licensing compliance, facilities, and budget oversight.

Director of Product Development • 1997 – 2012 • New York

Saks Off 5th • May Company (Style & Co, \$85M) • Macy's • Saurette (proprietary brand)

- Produced fashion shows across multiple private label brands throughout tenure as Product Development Director, including runway presentations for Saks Off 5th and Style & Co seasonal collections.
- Founded and served as Creative Director of Saurette (children's apparel brand, 2008–2014): personally handled all styling and art direction for runway shows, seasonal lookbooks, and marketing campaigns from concept through execution.
- Led design-to-production-to-sales cycle for private label apparel businesses ranging from \$26M to \$85M in annual volume across three major retailers. Bi-annual Far East travel for sourcing and development.

- Performed style design and research for monthly women's apparel collections at Saks Off 5th, informing product direction and market positioning.

Freelance Photo Stylist | Runway & Trunk Show Producer ▪ 1988 – 1997 ▪ New York & Chicago

NY Pret • *MR Magazine* • *Chicago Tribune* • *Marshall Field's* • *Montgomery Ward*

- Styled outfits for trade shows, special events, magazines, and newspapers across New York and Chicago, fitting themes given by editors at NY Pret, MR Magazine, and the Chicago Tribune Sunday fashion inserts.
- Served as stylist for the Chicago Tribune Sunday fashion inserts (1991–1996): editorial styling, layout collaboration, and on-set direction for weekly fashion coverage.
- Managed and produced runway shows and trunk shows for Marshall Field's across the Chicago area (1988–1990): model coordination, styling direction, show logistics, and on-site execution.

E d u c a t i o n

Bachelor of Science in Fashion Merchandising ▪ Western Michigan University ▪ Kalamazoo, MI

S k i l l s & T o o l s

Core Competencies: Fashion Show Production & Runway Direction, Photo Styling & Art Direction, End-to-End Event Project Management, RFP Development & Ownership, Vendor Selection & Agency Management, Cross-Functional Team Leadership, Budget Oversight & Reconciliation, Run-of-Show Development, Casting & Talent Coordination, Brand Presentation Decks, Risk Management, Post-Event Analysis, Private Label Product Development, Fashion Supply Chain.

Tools: Google Suite, Microsoft Suite, Airtable, Asana, Notion, Slack, Concur, Navan, Coupa, Zip, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe Lightroom, Gamma, ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity, Otter.ai.